

ABHISHEK RAO

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LinkedIn | GitHub | Medium

Solutions Architect with a strong record of driving technical wins in sales cycles, delivering secure and scalable solutions across enterprise networking, cloud, and Kubernetes environments. Skilled in pre-sales solution design, technical demos, workshops, and PoCs, with a foundation in leading large-scale programs and cross-functional teams. Combine customer-side leadership and technical depth to translate business goals into practical architectures that accelerate adoption. Known for exceeding expectations through client focus, sales alignment, and impactful enablement.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Tigera Inc. (Project Calico)

Pre-Sales Solutions Architect – *Led customer PoCs, demos & enablement for Kubernetes security and CNAPP adoption*
Vancouver, BC | Jan 2025 – Present

- Supported \$4.5M+ in sales pipeline and influenced \$2M+ in FY26 revenue by delivering high-impact PoCs and technical validation across strategic and Fortune 1000 accounts
- Drove cloud security adoption across CNAPP, runtime threat detection, and posture management, aligning Kubernetes workloads to Zero Trust and compliance requirements
- Delivered 20+ demos/workshops, aligning cloud and Kubernetes security with PCI, NIST & ISO 27001 needs
- Led 15+ PoCs across AWS, GKE, AKS & VKS, driving CNAPP adoption using Calico Cloud (SaaS) & Enterprise (On-Prem)
- Built GitHub tooling, demo scripts & guides now used across global SA and partner enablement teams
- Created training documents, diagrams, and decks to accelerate customer onboarding and internal enablement
- Collaborated with Product & Engineering to refine roadmap and close customer feedback loops

Wabtec Transportation Canada

Lead, Systems & Network Engineering – *Oversaw LRT program delivery, vendor coordination, and network design*
Edmonton, AB | Dec 2023 – Jan 2025

- Led large-scale LRT communication deployments across NA, managing project scope and stakeholder alignment
- Architected end-to-end transit networks using Cisco, Siemens, MOXA, and OTN Systems hardware
- Owned program budgets, resource planning, and vendor management for multimillion-dollar deliverables
- Defined risk mitigation strategies and created reporting frameworks for cross-segment collaboration
- Standardized configuration schemas and trained support teams for scalable Tier 1/2 operations

Sr. Systems & Network Engineer – *Designed and deployed large-scale LRT networks with resilient architecture*
Toronto, ON | July 2022 – Dec 2023

- Delivered LRT communication networks across NA and APAC for multimillion-dollar transit programs
- Architected resilient IP schemas and integrated hardware from Cisco, Siemens, MOXA, and OTN Systems
- Led documentation, config standardization, and trained technicians for Tier 1/2 support readiness
- Scoped and executed upgrades, ensuring minimal downtime for transit network clients

Wabtec Corporation

Network Engineer – *Built enterprise infrastructure and monitoring systems for light rail transit across U.S. clients*
Woodbury, MN, USA | July 2019 – July 2022

- Designed enterprise network infrastructure and deployed monitoring tools (e.g., SolarWinds) for LRT systems
- Created network policies, disaster recovery plans, and supported cross-team integration testing

PUBLIC CONTENT & ENABLEMENT

- Speaker at webinars and enablement sessions on Kubernetes security and Calico architecture
- Maintainer of internal GitHub repos and onboarding scripts adopted by global SA teams
- Author on Medium on topics related to Kubernetes, Cloud, and Security
- Regular attendee at KubeCon, KCDs, and Red Hat Summit to stay ahead on cloud-native and security trends

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Platforms:** Kubernetes, Calico, AWS, GCP, Azure, Red Hat, SUSE, VKS, On-Prem
- **Technologies:** CNAPP, Threat Detection, Bash, Python, REST APIs, Linux, GitHub Tooling, Zero Trust Architectures
- **Networking & Security:** BGP, Firewalls, VPC Networking, IDS/IPS, System Hardening, IPv4/IPv6

EDUCATION

Northeastern University, Boston - Master of Science: Telecommunication Systems Management

May 2019

Visvesvaraya Technological University, India - Bachelor of Engineering: Telecommunication Engineering

June 2016